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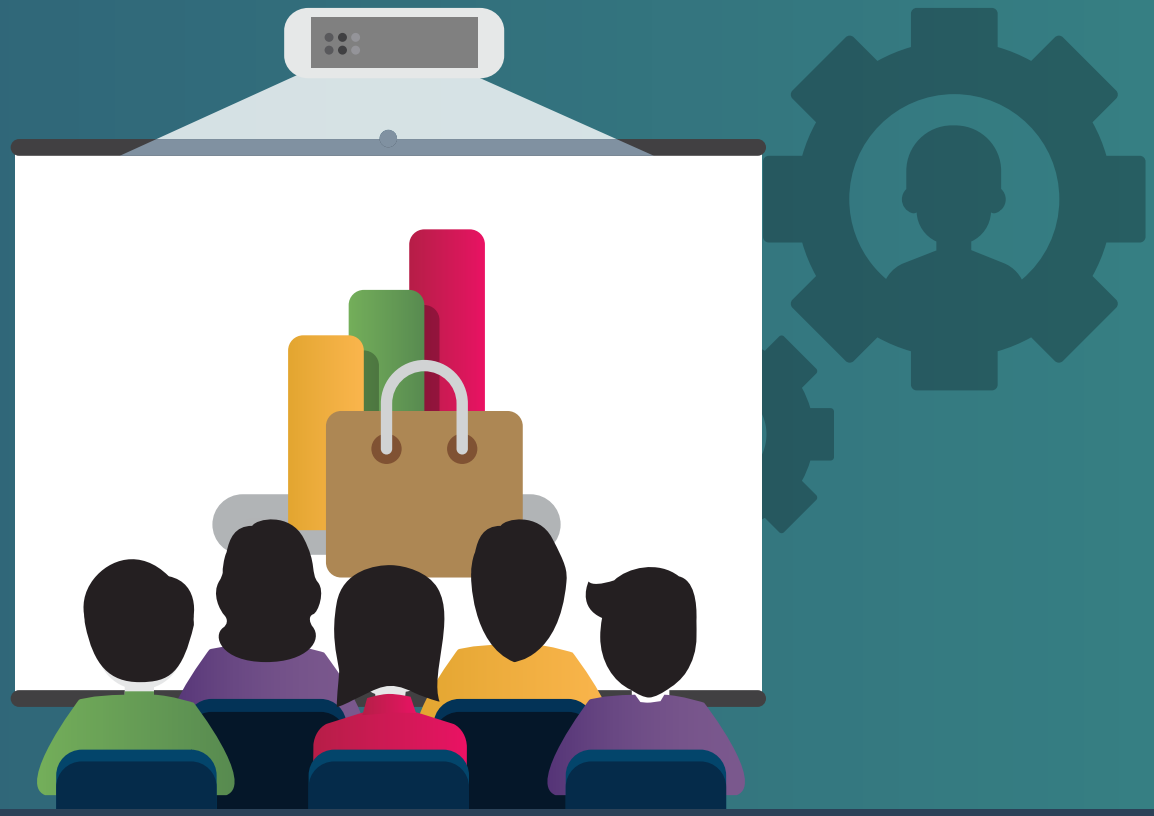
SALES TRAINING

Playbook & Toolkit



Follow this simple step-by-step playbook to **train Sales** on a consultative approach to selling that **increases your win-rate**, **dealsize** and **% reps attaining quota**.

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SALES TRAINING
Framework

Leverage the framework below to quickly empower your organization's sales training strategy.

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Click the buttons below to access all related training, tools, templates, and other resources.

1 ASSESS

- Sales Training Assessment
- Sales Skills Assessment
- Sales Enablement Strategy Scorecard

2 POSITION

- Customer Profile Tool
- Competitive Analysis Tool
- Unique Selling Proposition Template
- Competitive Products Sales Reference

3 PROCESS

- Buying Process Stage Template
- Qualified Lead Definition Tool
- Bid or No-Bid Assessment
- Sales Playbook Template

4 SELL

- SPIN Selling Questions Tool
- Feature Advantage Benefit Tool
- Sales Script Template
- Objection Responses Tool
- Sales Presentation Template
- Sales Proposal Template
- Territory Management Checklist
- Decision Maker Influencer Map

5 PLAN

- Account Scoring Template
- Key Account Analysis Tool
- Key Account Reporting Tool

6 MEASURE

- Sales Productivity Metrics (Daily)
- Sales Productivity Metrics (Monthly)
- Sales Productivity Metrics (Quarterly)
- Sales Forecasting Tool

SALES TRAINING
Maturity Model

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STAGE 1 - Undefined

- No CRM or Marketing Automation System in place
- Sales training is non-existent
- New reps hit quota in 9 mos.
- Sales Process & buying process are not defined
- Success metrics are unknown and not tracked
- Win Rate is less than 10%

STAGE 2 - Progressive

- CRM System in place with reasonable rep adoption
- Sales training is ad-hoc
- New reps hit quota in 6 mos.
- Sales process defined but not mapped to buying process
- Success metrics for top performing reps are known
- Win Rate is 10-20%

STAGE 3 - Mature

- CRM, Marketing Automation and Sales Enablement systems are in place
- Sales training occurs on a regular basis
- New reps hit quota in 4 mos.
- Sales process is mapped to buying process
- Success metrics tracked
- Win Rate is 20% or greater

STAGE 4 - World-Class

- All systems are accessible on mobile devices
- Sales reps are certified in sales training methodologies
- New reps hit quota in 3 mos.
- Sales process is continuously tweaked and improved upon
- Success metrics are managed closely to get reps performing
- Win Rate is 25% or greater

Want to rate your organization's Sales Training maturity with an interactive tool? Download our **Sales Training Maturity Assessment** and get started today!

VIEW RESOURCE

How to Use This Playbook

This playbook consists of six stages, each with a description, steps and action items. Action items include using our premium tools & templates. Our intention with this playbook is to help you:

Understand sales enablement and identify opportunities to improve your organization's capabilities

Evaluate and select the appropriate technology that will be the backbone of your enablement strategy

Plan and craft a strategy to drive adoption of Sales Playbooks by sales reps & channel partners

Outputs from This Playbook

Stage 1 - Assess Current Situation
Sales Training Assessment, Sales Skills Assessment

Stage 2 - Market Positioning
Customer Profile, Competitive Analysis, Unique Selling Proposition

Stage 3 - The Sales Process
Buying/Sales Process, Sales Playbook, Bid or No Bid Assessment

Stage 4 - Consultative Selling
Proposal, Presentation, Objection Responses, Influencer Map, Script

Stage 5 - Key Account Planning
Account Scoring, Key Account Analysis & Plans, Key Accounts Report

Stage 6 - Sales Metrics & Reports
Sales Productivity Metrics, Sales Forecast, Sales Forecasting Chart

Sales Enablement Defined

> "Consultative selling is based on the salesperson's ability to: act as a valued consultant to the prospect; identify their most pressing needs, challenges and points of pain; understand the impact of those needs in terms of risks & opportunities; and only then communicate solutions to those needs with related products and services."

Jesse Hopps
CEO at Demand Metric

Demand Metric's PATCHES Framework

Use this acronym to remember a solid framework for Sales Enablement in your organization:

P — **Playbooks:** build a Sales Playbook to equip reps with the knowledge, tools, and activities they need to succeed.

A — **Assets:** maintain content and digital assets in a system that allows sales reps to rate quality and usefulness.

T — **Training:** consider methodologies such as SPIN Selling or Miller Heiman to standardize your sales process.

C — **Commitment:** get a formal commitment from sales reps to use and rate all materials provided by Marketing.

H — **Hiring:** sales reps with the same skills and attitudes as your current star performers.

E — **Enabling Technology:** CRM, Marketing Automation and Sales Enablement systems should work on mobile devices.

S — **Sales Process:** map your sales process to the buying process and build content based on key buyer personas.

What Goes Inside a Sales Playbook?

A Sales Playbook is a collection of information, knowledge, sales tools, and activities that have been proven to assist with closing business in a variety of common sales situations.

You can structure your playbook like this:

- Company Overview
- Marketing Insights
- Sales Opportunities
- **Stage 1 –** Need / Prospecting
- **Stage 2 –** Discovery / Qualification
- **Stage 3 –** Consideration / Demo
- **Stage 4 –** Decision / Proposal
- **Stage 5 –** Review / Contract

STAGE 1

Assess Current Situation

In this Stage, you will focus your efforts around analyzing your current sales training process, identifying the skills gaps of your existing sales reps, and developing a plan for improving sales training going forward.

Key steps in this stage include:

STEP 1: Conduct a Sales Training Assessment
STEP 2: Assess Skills of Sales Team
STEP 3: Create a Sales Strategy Scorecard

STEP 1

Conduct a Sales Training Assessment

Action Item

Use the **Sales Training Assessment** to determine your organization's strengths and weaknesses when it comes to preparing your sales representatives to close deals.

Areas of the assessment include:

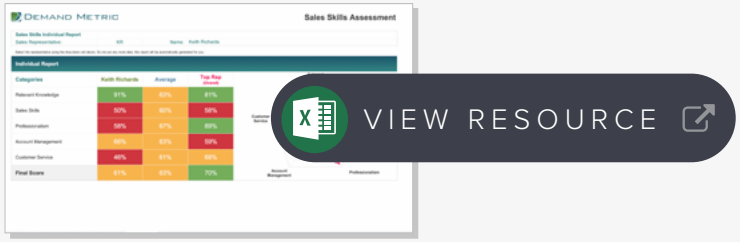
- Sales Process
- Self-Management & Planning
- Business Development
- Sales Presentations
- Relationship Management
- Closing Sales

STEP 2

Assess Skills of Sales Team

Action Item

Use the **Sales Skills Assessment** to evaluate the skills of your existing sales reps, compare all with your top rep and determine the team averages and areas of needed improvement.



Sections of the Skills Assessment include:

- Relevant Knowledge
- Sales Skills
- Professionalism
- Account Management
- Customer Service

STEP 3

Create a Strategy Scorecard

Action Item

Use the **Sales Enablement Strategy Scorecard** to document your high level sales enablement objectives, initiatives, KPIs and target timeframes.

Examples of common objectives include:

- Improve Average Deal Size
- Reduce Length of Sales Cycle
- Gain Adoption of Sales Playbook
- Audit Assets to Identify Gaps

SALES TRAINING

STAGE 2

Market Positioning

In this Stage you will start the training process by helping your sales team understand the market you operate in, needs of the buyers, key competitors, and how to differentiate your products and services.

You will perform the following actions to train Sales on your market position:

STEP 1: Communicate “Ideal” Customer Profile
STEP 2: Present In-Depth Competitive Analysis
STEP 3: Train Reps on Unique Selling Proposition
STEP 4: Provide Competitive Products Reference

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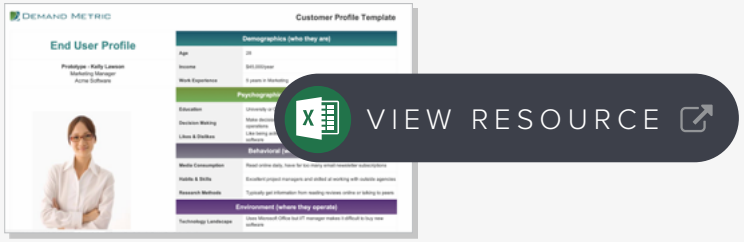
STEP 1

Communicate "Ideal" Customer Profile

Action Item

Use the **Customer Profile Tool** to share with sales reps information about the target customer company and the buyer personas in the decision making process they will encounter.



The Customer Profile should include information on:

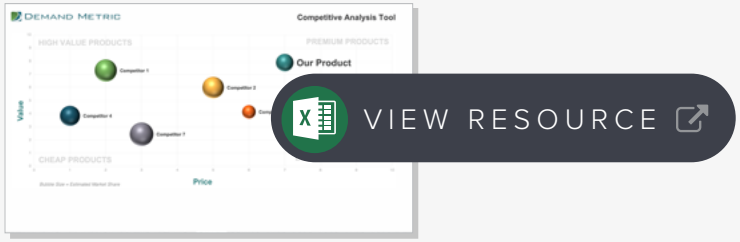
- Target Industries
- Company Size
- Location
- Environment
- Technical Buyers
- Economic Buyers
- End Users

STEP 2

Present In-Depth Competitive Analysis

Action Item

Use our **Competitive Analysis Tool** to highlight key competitors in your industry, their relative strengths and weakness, and how they are positioned on the competitive positioning map.



How can you categorize competitive product features:

- Offered
- Available via Partner
- Differentiator (category leader)
- Not Available

STEP 3

Train Reps on Unique Selling Proposition

Action Item

Use our **Unique Selling Proposition Template** to identify any unique selling features of your products to help sales reps differentiate your products when speaking with prospects.

Key information to include in your worksheet:

- Product Name
- Description
- Competitors
- Customers
- Product Features
- USP Statements

STEP 4

Provide Competitive Products Reference

Action Item

Use our **Competitive Products Sales Reference** to give sales reps a take-away from training that contains all competitive products and compares them feature-by-feature with your products.

This analysis will provide you with:

- Value Drivers
- Rankings
- Differentiation Chart
- Positioning Map
- Top 5 Competitor Profiles

STAGE 3

The Sales Process

In this Stage you will train sales reps on your standardized sales process.

Key activities include:

STEP 1: Map Buying & Selling Processes with Reps
STEP 2: Teach How to Qualify Sales Opportunities
STEP 3: Provide the Sales Playbook
STEP 4: Train Reps on Updating Your CRM System

Note: This playbook assumes you already have a SFA/CRM system in place.

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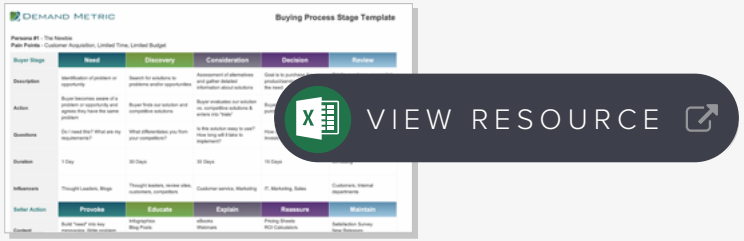
STEP 1

Map Buying & Selling Processes with Reps

Action Item

Use the **Buying Process Stage Template** to teach reps how your sales process aligns with the buying process and what actions need to happen at each stage of the process.



Key stages in the buying/selling process:

- Need / Prospecting
- Discovery / Qualification
- Consideration / Demo
- Decision / Proposal
- Purchase / Contract

STEP 2

Teach How to Qualify Sales Opportunities

Action Item

Use the **Qualified Lead Definition Tool** to outline to sales reps the key criteria required for a sales lead to be considered qualified. Also, use our **Bid or No-Bid Assessment** tool if appropriate.

Key qualification criteria:

- Company (size, industry, location)
- Contact (seniority level, decision-maker)
- Buying Stage & Needs
- Spending Authority
- Recentness of Activity (web visits, downloads, call, etc.)

STEP 3

Provide the Sales Playbook

Action Item

Use the **Sales Playbook Template** to develop strategies for selling in specific situations and then provide the playbook to sales reps and ask them to contribute advice for future versions.

What do Sales Playbooks provide:

- Buyer Personas
- Assets, Collateral & Content to Leverage
- Recent Wins
- Key Industry Verticals
- Sales Play Summaries

STEP 4

Train Reps on Updating Your CRM System

Action Item

Do a formal training session on how to update your CRM system at each stage of the buying/sales process and include screenshots in a guide they can take with them.

What information needs to be updated in the CRM system?

- Contact Information
- Opportunity Amount
- Key Objections
- Sales Process Stage
- Expected Close Date
- Decision-Makers

SALES TRAINING

STAGE 4

Consultative Selling

To this point, you have trained your sales reps on the market, your positioning and the sales process. Now, it's time to teach them the consultative selling techniques they will need to be successful.

In this Stage, you will train your reps on the following:

STEP 1: Asking Questions to Create Need
STEP 2: Relating Needs to Relevant Features
STEP 3: How to Communicate Value
STEP 4: How to Deal with Objections
STEP 5: How to Present Your Solution
STEP 6: How to Customize a Proposal
STEP 7: How to Manage Sales Territories
STEP 8: How to Analyze Stakeholders

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STEP 1

Asking Questions to Create Need

Action Item

Use the **SPIN Selling Questions Tool** to teach sales reps how to consult their prospects and customers, earn their trust and respect, and understand their most pressing business challenges.

Types of questions to ask:

- **Situation** (how long have you worked in I/T?)
- **Problem** (what is keeping you up at night?)
- **Implication** (what is the impact of an unsuccessful implementation?)
- **Need-Payoff** (how would success on this project affect your career?)

Note – This method is derived from Neil Rackham's **SPIN Selling** methodology.

STEP 2

Related Needs to Relevant Features

Action Item

Use the **Feature Advantage Benefit Tool** to teach sales reps how to relate the needs of their prospects to the right features of your product or solution.

What is the difference between an advantage and a benefit?

- **Advantages** – generic benefits of a given product feature (i.e. 'you will save time if you buy our product.')
- **Benefits** – real benefits only apply to prospects who have a need and will value the feature you are talking about. (i.e. 'based on our conversation, you should save 6 hours on your existing process by implementing our solution.')

STEP 3

How to Communicate Value

Action Item

Use the **Sales Script Template** to teach sales reps how to communicate the value propositions of the various features in your solution.

Key characteristics of a good script:

- **Real-World** – don't write the script too formally
- **Based on Success** – mimic your top sales rep's pitches
- **Humanized** – practice so reps don't sound scripted
- **Adaptable** – allow reps to put phrases into their own words
- **Specific** – should cover all value propositions and features

STEP 4

How to Deal with Objections

Action Item

Use the **Objection Response Tool** to teach sales reps how overcome the most common objections they are likely to face when selling your solution.

Framework for handling objections:

- **Soften** – show empathy ('I understand...")
- **Confirm** – paraphrase ('so what you are saying is...")
- **Respond** – provide a logical or emotional argument
- **Close** – use a trial-close ('do you see now why that's not such an issue? Great! Let's move forward!)

STEP 5

How to Present Your Solution

Action Item

Use the **Sales Presentation Template** to create a standardized sales presentation slide deck, and then train your sales reps on how to customize it depending on the selling situation.

Here is a proven format for presenting your solution:

- **Introductions** – show who is on the call today
- **Our Understanding** – the prospect's issues & needs
- **Our Approach** – how your solution meets those needs
- **Pricing** – solution costs and timeframe for delivery
- **Questions & Answers** – leave time for more dialogue
- **Contact Information** – how to reach each participant

STEP 6

How to Customize a Proposal

Action Item

Use the **Sales Proposal Template** to create a standardized sales proposal, and then train your sales reps on how to customize it depending on the selling situation.

A few tips for winning more proposals:

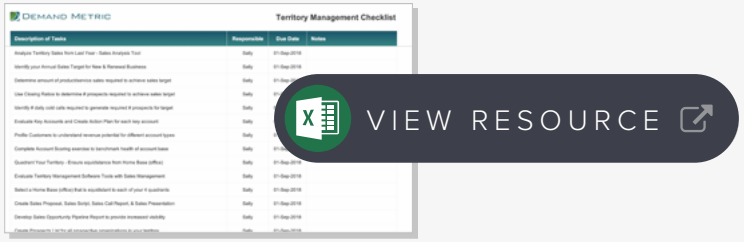
- **Quick Follow-Up** – deliver proposal within 24 hours
- **Proof Read** – ensure no spelling mistakes
- **Be Thorough** – avoid 'unsupervised' thinking
- **Pricing** – be clear and include all relevant costs
- **Guarantees** – include warranties and SLA

STEP 7

How to Manage Sales Territories

Action Item

Use the **Territory Management Checklist** to provide any outside sales reps with best practices related to efficiently working their assigned sales territory.



Here are some 'best practices' to consider:

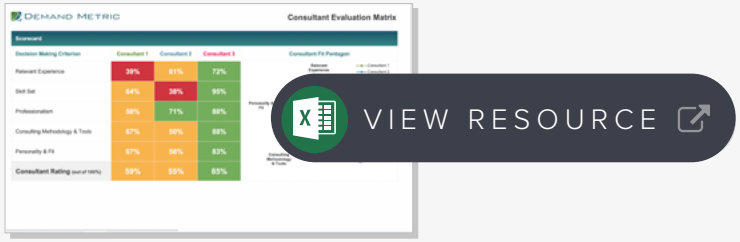
- Identify your sales quota for the year & average sale
- Determine the number of sales required to hit quota
- Use closing ratios to identify number of new prospects required
- Figure out number of contact requests needed to generate prospects
- Create Key Account Plans for any large accounts

STEP 8

How to Analyze Key Stakeholders

Action Item

Use the **Decision Maker Influencer Map** tool to teach sales reps how they can evaluate all stakeholders involved in a complex sales process, and identify strategies to influence the deal.



What goes into an influencer map?

- Stakeholder Name
- Decision Maker Role (executive, technical buyer)
- Interest – how interested is the stakeholder in the project?
- Power – how much power does this person have?
- Buy-In – what is their level of support?
- Flexibility – how likely are they to change their mind?

STAGE 5

Key Account Planning

In this Stage you will be training your reps on how to score their accounts, analyze key accounts, develop an action plan for each, and then report on the status of each key account.

The training you will be rolling out to sales reps in this stage include:

STEP 1: How to Score Accounts
STEP 2: How to Analyze & Plan for Key Accounts
STEP 3: How to Report on Key Accounts

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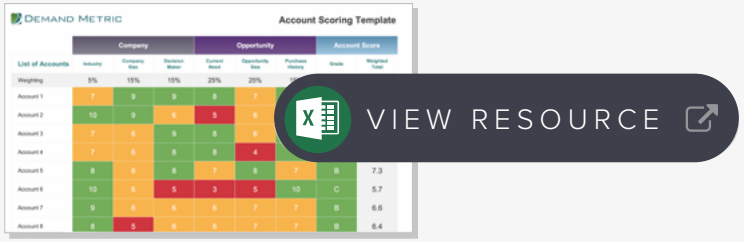
STEP 1

How to Score Accounts

Action Item

Use the **Account Scoring Template** to train sales reps on how they can score each of their accounts to identify the key accounts in their customer-base or sales territory.



What criteria can you use to score accounts?

- Industry
- Company Size
- Decision Maker
- Current Need
- Opportunity Size
- Purchase History

STEP 2

How to Analyze & Plan for Key Accounts

Action Item

Use the **Key Account Analysis Tool** to train sales reps on how to identify sales opportunities and develop key account action plans within their selected group of key accounts.

What goes into a key account analysis & action plan?

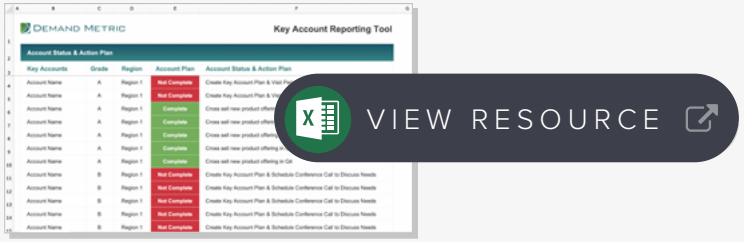
- Account Intelligence & Unknowns
- Current & Forecasted Sales
- Value Chain
- Key Success Factors
- Competition
- Action Plan

STEP 3

How to Report on Key Accounts

Action Item

Use the **Key Account Reporting Tool** to train sales reps on how to report back to sales management on each of their key accounts.



What information needs to be reported?

- Account Name
- Account Grade or Score (A,B,C,D)
- Region or Territory
- Account Plan Status (complete or not complete)
- Account Status & Action Items

STAGE 6

Sales Metrics & Reports

Now that you have trained your sales reps on the consultative selling techniques required to be successful in the field, you need to complete the training by providing insight into how their productivity metrics will be tracked, and how they need to report on their sales funnel.

Steps in this Stage include:

STEP 1: Training on Productivity Metrics
STEP 2: How to Forecast Sales

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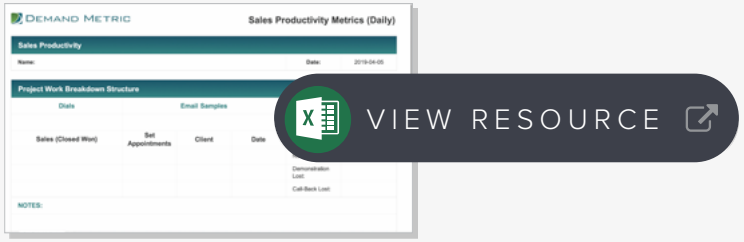
STEP 1

Training on Sales Productivity Metrics

Action Item

Use our Sales Productivity Metrics (**Daily**, **Monthly**, **Quarterly**) to train sales reps on which metrics will be tracked and what they need to do on a daily basis to be successful.



Following are some key metrics you want to analyze:

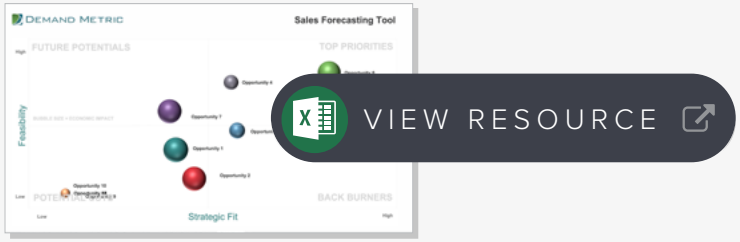
- Number of Sales
- Revenue
- Closing Ratios
- Dials/Day
- Number of New Prospects (set appointments)
- Number of Demos

STEP 2

How to Forecast Sales

Action Item

Use our **Sales Forecasting Tool** and **Sales Forecasting Chart** to train sales reps on how to report on their funnel if you do not already have a SFA/CRM system in place.



What information needs to go into the Sales Forecast?

- Sales Stage
- Probability
- Expected Revenue
- Prospect/Customer
- Product or Service
- Close Date

Conclusion

- **At the end of any project, it's always a good idea to review it and identify areas for improvement.**
- **Demand Metric has the tools and expertise to help you build an effective Sales Training program:**
  - Creating or auditing your existing Sales Playbook
  - Assisting with using any of the tools referenced in this playbook
  - Providing hands-on marketing assistance to accelerate achieving your marketing department's goals.

About ANA

The **ANA (Association of National Advertisers)** makes a difference for individuals, brands, and the industry by driving growth, advancing the interests of marketers and promoting and protecting the well-being of the marketing community.

Founded in 1910, the ANA provides leadership that advances marketing excellence and shapes the future of the industry. The ANA's membership includes more than 1,000 companies with 15,000 brands that collectively spend or support more than $400 billion in marketing and advertising annually. The membership is comprised of more than 750 client-side marketers and 300 associate members, which include leading agencies, law firms, suppliers, consultants, and vendors.

Further enriching the ecosystem is the work of the nonprofit ANA Educational Foundation (AEF), which has the mission of enhancing the understanding of advertising and marketing within the academic and marketing communities.

About Demand Metric

DEMAND METRIC

Demand Metric helps Marketing teams get stuff done with practical tools, training, and a simple, modern platform for managing work.

Our analysts identify best practices from fast-growing companies and build Playbooks & Toolkits, Guides & Reports, Training Courses, and Project Templates to help you optimize your processes, add structure to your department, and get your team punching above their weight class.

Manage your work visually with our easy-to-use platform, built for small marketing teams by design. See what your team is working on at a glance so you can spend less time managing projects and more time knocking stuff off your list.

Through strategic partnerships with the AMA, ANA, and AIPMM, our 1,000+ time-saving tools & resources have become the industry standard. Don't start from scratch!

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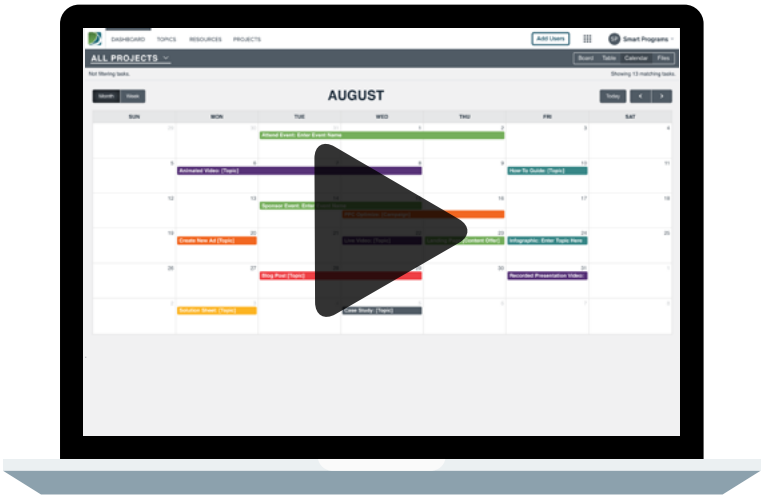

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